

The practice intelligence layer

Not software that does taxes. A system that prepares every engagement **before judgment begins** — what changed, what’s missing, what to ask — with every number linked to the exact source page it came from. The accountant reviews, decides, and signs. Always.

THE BOTTLENECK IS INTAKE AND RECONCILIATION — NOT JUDGMENT

TODAY	Documents trickle in · someone pulls last year’s file · checks it line by line · emails for what’s missing · waits · then the real work starts
WITH THE LAYER	Documents land where they already do (TaxDome) · parsed and reconciled against their own printed totals · a one-page briefing: changes, gaps, questions · the accountant starts at the review

THE RULE THAT MAKES IT TRUSTWORTHY

Nothing publishes unless it ties out.

If a document’s numbers fail to reconcile against its own printed control totals, the build halts and no report exists. This is not a promise — it is **running in production today**: Public Ledger reads the City of North Tonawanda’s published warrant PDFs — **36 of 36** machine-readable documents reconciled to the penny, 8,532 line items, \$28.1M — and cannot show a number that failed its own check.

✓ ALL GATES PASS: name fidelity · expenditure tie-out · row count · list amount – actual output of the last build

A bank statement prints its balances. A transcript prints its totals. Last year’s return is the baseline. Same gate, different letterhead.

THE PLAN — EACH PHASE ITS OWN WIN

01 · NOW → DECEMBER Bookkeeping pilot Five friendly clients. Bank and card statements in, reconciled to their own printed balances, a monthly exception brief out: uncategorized items, anomalies against that client’s own history, missing documents. Measured in minutes saved per close — proven before tax season opens.	02 · JANUARY → APRIL Tax review assist A one-page briefing per return, before review: prior-year deltas, a missing-document checklist (IRS transcript diff for extensions), flags with links to source pages. Extraction stays commodity — GruntWorx, SurePrep, or the software’s own scan. The gate and the briefing are ours.	03 · LATER Buy, don’t build Intake stays in TaxDome — clients already live there. Document OCR is bought, never rebuilt. No new portal, no tax engine, no rip-and-replace. The layer enhances the tools the practice already trusts.
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BUILT TO THE PRACTICE’S OWN OBLIGATIONS

IRC §7216 — return information is criminally protected: processing runs on a machine in the office, and nothing reaches any third-party model without written consent and zero-retention terms. **FTC Safeguards Rule** — the firm’s written security plan (IRS Pub 4557) is the design document: encryption, access controls, an audit log for every action, explicit deletion. And **every extracted number carries a link to its exact source page**, so review is fast and human judgment stays in charge.

SUCCESS METRIC 30–60 minutes returned per engagement — measured, not estimated.	FIRST STEP One friendly client’s last three bank statements, with written consent. Two weeks later: the reconciled brief.	PREPARED BY Joe Curry · Curry Studio demo: jcurry44.github.io/public-ledger
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